Data Description

Column Name	Data Type	Description
Facility ID	String/Text	Unique identifier assigned by CMS for each hospital (e.g., “010001”). Use as the primary key in your Hospital table.
Facility Name	String/Text	Full name of the hospital (e.g., “SOUTHEAST HEALTH MEDICAL CENTER”).
Address	String/Text	Street address of the hospital (e.g., “1108 ROSS CLARK CIRCLE”). Generally used for drill-through or detail views, not as a slicer.
City/Town	String/Text	City or town where the hospital is located (e.g., “DOTHAN”). Useful for geographic grouping alongside State and ZIP.
State	String/Text	Two-letter U.S. postal code for the state (e.g., “AL,” “CA”). Use for filtering or mapping at the state level.
ZIP Code	Integer	Five-digit ZIP code (e.g., 36301, 35957). You may convert to Text in Power BI to preserve any leading zeros (e.g., “01234”).
County/Parish	String/Text	Name of the county or parish (e.g., “HOUSTON”). Use for county-level geographic analysis.
Telephone Number	String/Text	Hospital main phone number (e.g., “(334) 793-8701”). Primarily for display; not typically used in slicing or grouping.
Hospital Type	String/Text	Category of hospital (e.g., “Acute Care Hospitals,” “Critical Access Hospitals,” “Long Term Care Hospitals”). Useful for grouping or filtering by facility type.
Hospital Ownership	String/Text	Ownership classification (e.g., “Government - Hospital District or Authority,” “Proprietary,” “Voluntary non-profit – Church“). Use to compare public vs private vs non-profit performance.

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Emergency Services	String/Text	“Yes” or “No” flag indicating whether the hospital offers emergency services. Convert to Boolean or drop as a slicer in Power BI.
Meets criteria for meaningful use stage 2	String/Text	“Yes” or “No” indicator showing whether the hospital met CMS Meaningful Use Stage 2 for electronic health record adoption. Useful for IT/informatics analyses.
Meets criteria for rural	String/Text	“Yes” or “No” flag indicating whether the hospital qualifies as a rural facility. Use to compare rural vs urban performance.
Number of certified beds	Integer	Total number of certified inpatient beds (e.g., 305, 25). Use to normalize volume metrics or as a size indicator in scatter plots.
Phone Number	String/Text	Secondary or alternative contact number (sometimes blank). Primarily for reference.
Hospital overall rating	String/Text	Composite rating from 1 to 5 based on multiple quality domains (e.g., “4,” “3,” “Not Available”). Convert to Whole Number (1–5) and treat “Not Available” as null for numeric calculations.
Mort Group Measure Count	Integer	Total number of mortality-related measures reported for this hospital (e.g., 7, 5). Use to validate that each hospital has the correct number of mortality measures.
Count of Facility Mort Measures	Integer	Actual number of mortality measures measured (e.g., 7, 5). Matches Mort Group Measure Count for most hospitals; if lower, some measures may be missing or suppressed.
Count of Mort Measures Better	Integer	Number of mortality measures in which this hospital performed “Better” than the national benchmark (e.g., 3, 2).
Count of Mort Measures No Different	Integer	Number of mortality measures in which performance was “No Different” from the benchmark (e.g., 2, 1).
Count of Mort Measures Worse	Integer	Number of mortality measures in which performance was “Worse” (e.g., 2, 2).
Mort Group Footnote	String/Text	Footnote text associated with mortality measures (e.g., explanations of data suppression or measure definitions). Often blank (“”).

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Safety Group Measure Count	Integer	Total number of safety-related measures reported (e.g., 9, 7).
Count of Facility Safety Measures	Integer	Actual number of safety measures measured for this hospital.
Count of Safety Measures Better	Integer	Number of safety measures with “Better” performance (e.g., 5, 4).
Count of Safety Measures No Different	Integer	Number of safety measures with “No Different” from benchmark (e.g., 3, 2).
Count of Safety Measures Worse	Integer	Number of safety measures with “Worse” performance (e.g., 1, 1).
Safety Group Footnote	String/Text	Footnote for safety measures (e.g., “Data not compared to national benchmark for low-volume hospitals”).
READM Group Measure Count	Integer	Total number of readmissions-related measures reported (e.g., 5, 4).
Count of Facility READM Measures	Integer	Actual number of readmission measures measured (should match READM Group Measure Count).
Count of READM Measures Better	Integer	Number of readmission measures with “Better” performance (e.g., 3, 2).
Count of READM Measures No Different	Integer	Number of readmission measures with “No Different” performance (e.g., 1, 1).
Count of READM Measures Worse	Integer	Number of readmission measures with “Worse” performance (e.g., 1, 1).
READM Group Footnote	String/Text	Footnote text for readmission measures (e.g., “National benchmark not available for small hospitals”).
Pt Exp Group Measure Count	Integer	Total number of patient experience measures reported (e.g., 10, 8).
Count of Facility Pt Exp Measures	Integer	Actual number of patient experience measures (should match Pt Exp Group Measure Count).
Pt Exp Group Footnote	String/Text	Footnote text for patient experience domain (e.g., “Survey conducted by HCAHPS”).

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TE Group Measure Count	Integer	Total number of Timely and Effective Care measures (e.g., 7, 6).
Count of Facility TE Measures	Integer	Actual number of Timely and Effective Care measures measured.
TE Group Footnote	String/Text	Footnote for Timely and Effective Care domain (e.g., “Reporting period did not include all measure removal dates”).

Notes & Tips

1. Facility ID, Facility Name, Address, City/Town, State, ZIP Code, County/Parish, Telephone Number
    - These are basic identifying and geographic columns.
    - Convert ZIP Code to Text in Power Query to keep any leading zeros and ensure correct joins to external ZIP/county shape files.
    - Use Address and Telephone Number for drill-through/detail purposes only—they should be hidden from slicers and filters.
2. Hospital Type & Hospital Ownership
    - Text fields that may have multiple categorical values (e.g., “Critical Access Hospitals,” “Proprietary”). Consider creating lookup tables if you need to group or retire rare categories.
    - Can be used as slicers or legends in visuals to compare performance across ownership types (e.g., Government vs Non-Profit vs Proprietary).
3. Emergency Services, Meets criteria for meaningful use stage 2, Meets criteria for rural
    - “Yes”/“No” flags. Convert to Boolean or whole number (1/0) so that you can easily count how many hospitals have emergency services or are rural.
    - Use these to filter or compare subsets (e.g., rural hospitals vs urban hospitals).

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4. Number of certified beds
    - Convert to Whole Number.
    - Use as a measure of hospital size. You can create bins or buckets (e.g., <50 beds, 50–200 beds, >200 beds) if needed for segmentation.
5. Hospital overall rating
    - Reported as a 1–5 scale, but some rows may have "Not Available."
    - Convert to Whole Number and treat "Not Available" as blank (NULL).
    - Use in visuals (e.g., map colored by overall rating, bar chart of rating distribution).
6. Group Measure Counts (Mort, Safety, READM, Pt Exp, TE)
    - Each domain has three columns:
        - "Group Measure Count" = total measures defined for that domain.
        - "Count of Facility … Measures" = number actually reported.
        - Three columns for "Better," "No Different," "Worse" counts.
    - E.g., for Mortality (MORT):
        - *Mort Group Measure Count* = number of mortality measures CMS tracks (e.g., 7).
        - *Count of Facility Mort Measures* = how many hospital reports (should be the same unless suppressed).
        - *Count of Mort Measures Better/No Different/Worse* = performance breakdown.

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- Create calculated measures in DAX for:
  - % Better = DIVIDE([Count of … Better], [Count of Facility … Measures])
  - % Worse = DIVIDE([Count of … Worse], [Count of Facility … Measures])
- Use these to compare domains across hospitals.

7. Footnote Columns
   - Text fields providing caveats or explanations (e.g., “National benchmark not available,” “Data not reported due to small sample size”).
   - Display these as tooltip text or in a “Notes” column on detail pages. Don’t aggregate them in visuals—they’re purely descriptive.

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